

—MILLERS—

Schroll Hurls Four-Hitter

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Manager Andy Cohen's pitching gamble for Denver turned into money in the bank for Minneapolis in the form of a 10-1 victory in the American Association final playoff opener Thursday night.

A crowd of 1,579 customers at Metropolitan stadium saw the third-place Millers take a 1-0 advantage in the best-of-seven series over the fourth-place Bears.

STAKED to a three-run lead in the first inning when the Millers chased rookie right-hander Leigh Lawrence, right-hander Al Schroll strong-armed the Bears with a four-hitter.

Minneapolis whacked three Denver hurlers for 12 hits, led by Manager Gene Mauch's three singles and Paul Smith's three RBI's.

With tonight's game in Minneapolis and the remainder of the playoff in Denver, Cohen virtually conceded the opener by giving the 23-year-old Lawrence his first start of the year to rest his staff after a gruelling elimination of Charleston.

"I **HAD** to get my staff in shape," explained Cohen, "but now I've got John Gabler ready for Friday night here and Ben Flowers and Mark Freeman set for Saturday and Sunday back in Denver."

In the first round, streak-hitting Stu Locklin led with a single through the middle and Pumpsie Green walked. Smith took a third strike but Art Schult doubled down the left field line scoring Locklin. Red Robbins grounded a single to left for a 3-0 Miller start.

DENVER picked up a single tally in the second. Zeke Bella, who injured his leg later in the game on a collision at first base and had to leave, singled to right and the AA's 1958 batting champion with a .328 mark, Gordon Windhorn, doubled into the left corner to chase Bella home.

It became 5-1 in the Millers last half off Stan Johnson on Schroll's triple to right center, a walk to Green and Smith's single to right for two runs, Green scoring from first on a delayed relay. Three more tumbled over in the third on a walk to Tom Umphlett, Mauch's hit-run single through shortstop, Jerry Zimmerman's single, two more walks and Smith's sacrifice fly.

The Millers scored unearned runs in the sixth and seventh off the relieving Charlie Templeton.

Schroll breezed by the Bears, failing to allow a hit from the third until the eighth when right-fielder Lu Clinton fell down to give George Wilson a double.